CORE FALSE BELIEF #7 · MY STRENGTH

“I cannot make it on my own.”

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Where it often comes from

This belief can develop when a person was overprotected, never allowed to make decisions, or told they were incapable. It can also follow years of depending on a spouse, parent, or caregiver, or a loss that left someone suddenly alone. The belief is partly true, because we all need God and other people. It becomes harmful when it turns into fear of being alone, staying in unhealthy relationships, or giving up our own decisions.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture honors healthy dependence. Two are better than one, and God settles the lonely in families. Our ultimate dependence is on the Lord, who holds our right hand and helps us. But the Bible also calls each person to carry his own load and to grow in maturity. Needing God and others does not mean you are helpless. God has given you abilities, judgment, and His Spirit. You can lean on Him and on safe people while also taking responsibility for your own life.

> *“For I am the LORD your God, who takes hold of your right hand and tells you: Do not fear, I will help you”* (Isaiah 41:13).

Also see

> “I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth” (Psalm 121:1–2).

> “Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!” (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

> “Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else. For each one should carry his own load” (Galatians 6:4–5).

> “Not that we are competent in ourselves to claim that anything comes from us, but our competence comes from God” (2 Corinthians 3:5).

Common self-statements

- I need someone to take care of me.
- I can’t make decisions on my own.
- If I lose this person, I’ll fall apart.
- I’m not capable of running my life.
- I’ll put up with anything rather than be alone.
- Others know better than I do.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing that if I need help with some things, I can’t do anything on my own.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will fail if I try to stand on my own.
- Discounting the positive: Overlooking the things I already do well by myself.
- Catastrophizing: Imagining that being alone would be unbearable.

Challenging questions

- What do I already do on my own, even if I don't notice it?
- Who taught me that I couldn't manage by myself?
- Is there a difference between needing help and being helpless?
- Am I staying in anything unhealthy because I fear being alone?
- What does God say about His help and my responsibility?
- What is one decision I can make myself this week?

Truth summary

> I need God, and I need people; that is how He made me. But needing help does not mean I am helpless. God holds my hand and has given me abilities and judgment. I can take responsibility for my life, make my own decisions, and still lean on Him and on safe people.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Help
- Strength
- Trust
- Guidance
- Plans

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Weak/Tired
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

He Knows — Jeremy Camp
Jesus understands suffering and invites people to bring their burdens to Him.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Glorious Unfolding — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's story continues beyond a painful or confusing chapter.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I cannot make it on my own"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I cannot make it on my own." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I already do on my own?
- ☐ Who taught me I couldn't manage?
- ☐ What is the difference between needing help and being helpless?
- ☐ Am I staying in something unhealthy out of fear?
- ☐ What does God say about His help and my part?
- ☐ What decision can I make myself?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ My help comes from the Lord.
- ☐ Needing help is not the same as being helpless.
- ☐ God has given me abilities and judgment.
- ☐ I can make decisions and learn from them.
- ☐ Healthy relationships are chosen, not clung to.
- ☐ God holds my right hand.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Isaiah 41:13
  "For I am the LORD your God, who takes hold of your right hand and tells you: Do not fear, I will help you."
- ☐ Psalm 121:1–2
  "I lift up my eyes to the hills. From where does my help come? My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth."
- ☐ Galatians 6:4–5
  "Each one should test his own work. Then he will have reason to boast in himself alone, and not in someone else. For each one should carry his own load."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Things I did on my own: Each day, write one thing you handled or decided yourself, and how it went.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 41:13 becomes: "Maria can write: "The Lord holds my right hand. With His help, I can take the next step myself.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Help" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] List what you already do. Write down every task you already handle on your own. Include small things. Read the list when you feel helpless.
- [ ] Make one decision yourself. Choose one decision you would normally hand to someone else, make it, and notice what happens.
- [ ] Learn one new skill. Pick one practical skill, such as paying a bill online or cooking a simple meal, and learn it this week.
- [ ] Widen your circle. Add one more safe person or group to your life so you are not relying on just one person.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I cannot make it on my own": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something I handled myself
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I cannot make it on my own.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I lean on You, and I thank You for the people You have given me. Help me see the abilities You have placed in me. Give me courage to take responsibility, make decisions, and grow, knowing You hold my hand. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.